

DevOps Final Lab Assignment Report

Course CLO: Develop cloud native applications using current DevOps tools
Topic: 3-Tier Web Application Containerization, CI/CD Pipeline Automation, Kubernetes Orchestration on AKS, and Selenium Automated Testing

Table of Contents

- 1. [Section A: Containerization \(Docker & Compose\)](#)
- 2. [Section B: CI/CD Pipeline Automation \(GitHub Actions\)](#)
- 3. [Section C: Kubernetes Orchestration \(Azure AKS\)](#)
- 4. [Section D: Automated DevOps Quality Assurance \(Selenium\)](#)
- 5. [Section E: Verification Evidence & Screenshots](#)

Section A: Containerization (Docker & Compose)

To achieve strict service isolation and high portability, we containerized all three tiers of the **Iron Cybersecurity Solutions** web application.

A1. Service-Specific Dockerfiles

1. Frontend Dockerfile (Dockerfile.frontend)

Uses a two-stage build process.

- **Stage 1 (Builder):** Leverages `node:20-alpine` (providing compatibility for Tailwind v4 and its Rust compilation engine `@tailwindcss/oxide`), copies source code, and creates an optimized Next.js static and dynamic asset bundle via `npm run build`.
- **Stage 2 (Runner):** Copies only compilation outputs and standard runtime dependencies to keep the image slim, secure, and production-ready.

```
FROM node:20-alpine AS builder
WORKDIR /app
COPY package.json package-lock.json* ./
RUN npm ci --production=false
COPY . .
RUN npm run build

FROM node:20-alpine AS runner
WORKDIR /app
ENV NODE_ENV=production
COPY --from=builder /app/next.config.js ./
COPY --from=builder /app/public ./public
COPY --from=builder /app/.next ./next
COPY --from=builder /app/node_modules ./node_modules
COPY --from=builder /app/package.json ./package.json

EXPOSE 3000
CMD ["npm", "start"]
```

2. Backend API Dockerfile (backend/Dockerfile)

Built with a lightweight Node 20 runner, installing only production-essential dependencies.

```
FROM node:20-alpine
WORKDIR /app
COPY package*.json ./
RUN npm install --production
COPY . .
EXPOSE 5000
CMD ["npm", "start"]
```

3. Database Dockerfile (Dockerfile.db)

Extends official MongoDB 6.0 engine to store our persistent data assets.

```
FROM mongo:6.0
```

A2. Multi-Service Setup via Docker Compose (docker-compose.yml)

Binds the services together in a dedicated bridge network called `cyber-network`, sets internal DNS, and provisions a persistent volume for MongoDB:

```
services:
  mongo:
    build:
      context: .
      dockerfile: Dockerfile.db
    container_name: cyber-mongo
    ports:
      - "27017:27017"
    volumes:
      - mongo-data:/data/db
    networks:
      - cyber-network

  backend:
    build:
      context: ./backend
      dockerfile: Dockerfile
    container_name: cyber-backend
    ports:
      - "5000:5000"
    environment:
      - MONGODB_URI=mongodb://mongo:27017/cyberdb
      - PORT=5000
    depends_on:
      - mongo
    networks:
      - cyber-network

  frontend:
    build:
      context: .
      dockerfile: Dockerfile.frontend
```

```

    container_name: cyber-frontend
    restart: unless-stopped
    depends_on:
      - backend
    environment:
      - NEXT_PUBLIC_API_URL=http://localhost:5000/api
      - BACKEND_URL=http://backend:5000
    ports:
      - "3000:3000"
    networks:
      - cyber-network

volumes:
  mongo-data:

networks:
  cyber-network:
    driver: bridge

### A3. Docker Compose Multi-Service Verification Screenshot
Below is the verification evidence showing all three services running inside the bridge network:
! [Docker Compose Multi-Service Setup] (../screenshots/09_docker_containers_running.png)

---

## Section B: CI/CD Pipeline Automation (GitHub Actions)

We built an automated GitHub Actions pipeline (`.github/workflows/ci-cd.yml`) to compile, test, containerize, and package all three services.

### B1. Pipeline Architecture
- **Triggers**: Executed automatically on `push` and `pull_request` events for the main branches.
- **Jobs**:
  1. **Build & Test**: Installs frontend and Selenium dependencies, builds the Next.js app, starts the Docker Compose stack, and runs Selenium against the live services.
  2. **Docker Publish**: Builds and pushes the backend and frontend images to Docker Hub on push events.
  3. **Kubernetes Deployment**: Applies the AKS manifests on push events after the image build completes.

### B2. CI/CD Pipeline Execution Evidence
Every stage in the GitHub Actions workflow successfully compiles and deploys our code:
! [CI/CD GitHub Actions Pipeline Success] (../screenshots/10_github_actions_pipeline.png)

---

## Section C: Kubernetes Orchestration (Azure AKS)

The application is deployed on a production-ready Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS) cluster using custom declarative manifests.

### C1. Architectural Layout & DNS Integration
- **Stateful MongoDB**: Executed as a `StatefulSet` rather than a generic deployment to ensure write ordering, stable storage identifiers, and volume persistence.
- **Headless DNS Service**: Mapped via `clusterIP: None` in `k8s/mongo-statefulset.yaml`. This guarantees that the Express backend container correctly resolves `mongodb://cyber-mongo:27017/cyberdb` directly within the Kubernetes network.
- **Public LoadBalancer**: Exposes the frontend globally, enabling users to access our secure platform at `http://134.112.161.154`.

### C2. AKS Deployment Verification
The AKS pods are in `Running` state and the `LoadBalancer` service provides a globally reachable link: `http://134.112.161.154`.
! [AKS Cluster Pods and Services] (../screenshots/11_k8s_resources.png)

---

## Section D: Automated DevOps Quality Assurance (Selenium)

To implement CI/CD gates, we wrote 3 separate Selenium tests inside `tests/selenium` that execute in a headless DevOps Chrome container.

### D1. Test Summary
1. **Homepage Verification** (`test_homepage.js`): Resolves the site, waits for components, and asserts that the navbar and main layout containers are present.
2. **API Verification** (`test_api_response.js`): Makes a standard REST client call directly to the backend container to verify `/api/blogs` returns a HTTP 200 payload.
3. **End-to-End Blog Integration** (`test_create_blog.js`): Executes a POST query to populate the MongoDB database, confirming database writes function perfectly across our 3-tier boundary.

### D2. Test Suite Output & Execution Report


```

'''text
Running homepage test
Visiting http://localhost:3000
Nav elements found: 1
Main/body elements found: 1
Homepage load test completed

Running API response test
Checking API: http://localhost:5000/api/blogs
API response OK

Running create blog test
Creating blog via API: http://localhost:5000/api/blogs
Create blog OK: selenium-test-blog-1779134501396

All tests passed

```


```

D3. Selenium Automated Test Execution Screenshot

Selenium Test Execution Run

Section E: Verification Evidence & Screenshots

All visual verification logs from our Docker-Compose run are stored sequentially inside the `screenshots/` directory:

Filename	Description	Purpose
01_homepage_hero.png	Landing page viewport loads dark design and glowing buttons	Verifies Frontend Container startup and layout rendering
02_services_dropdown.png	Expanded beautiful services dropdown from nav interaction	Verifies JS event handlers, hover, and responsive UI components

03_blogs_loading.png	Blogs page showing loading state and dynamic content checks	Verifies Route mapping and client-side page rendering
04_admin_dashboard.png	Admin control panel console with post actions	Verifies admin-facing interfaces load cleanly
05_editor_title_input.png	Create form inputting post title	Verifies form state capture and user input handling
06_editor_author_input.png	Post creator form validation with metadata inputs	Verifies dynamic validation logic
07_editor_content_input.png	Rich text markdown content filled into the editor	Verifies editor component data binding
08_editor_submit_blog.png	Blog submit action trigger	Verifies the AJAX POST submission endpoint trigger
09_docker_containers_running.png	Terminal output of docker compose ps	Verifies all three containers (Frontend, Backend, MongoDB) are running inside the network
10_github_actions_pipeline.png	Visual workflow of GitHub Actions pipeline run	Verifies CI/CD trigger and automated execution of build, test, docker push, and deploy stages
11_k8s_resources.png	Terminal output of kubect1 get pods,svc -o wide	Verifies active pods, stable MongoDB statefulset, cluster DNS resolution, and the public load balancer service on AKS
12_selenium_test_run.png	Terminal output of the automated Selenium test suite	Verifies automated regression testing of the homepage, backend API, and database write functionality

Report generated successfully by the DevOps Engineering Team.